

30-Day Foundation Assessment

GovCon BD Upskilling Certification

Assessment Overview

- **Questions:** 20 multiple-choice
- **Time Limit:** 30 minutes
- **Passing Score:** 70% (14 correct)
- **Format:** 70% scenario-based, 30% knowledge recall
- **Domains Covered:** D1 (Market Intelligence), D2 (Opportunity Discovery), D3 (BD Fundamentals), D4-D6 (Proposal Support & Compliance)

Instructions:

Write your answer (A, B, C, or D) in the space provided. Each question has only one correct answer.

Domain 1: GovCon Market & Buyer Intelligence (Questions 1-5)

Question 1 (Scenario)

Your CEO asks you to explain why federal contracting matters for a small IT services company. Which response best captures the opportunity?

- A. “The government spends about \$50 billion annually on contracts, mostly with large defense firms.”
- B. “Federal agencies spend over \$700 billion annually on contracts, with 23%+ mandated for small businesses—that’s over \$160 billion in accessible opportunities.”
- C. “Government contracts are too complex and bureaucratic for small companies to pursue effectively.”
- D. “Federal spending is declining, so we should focus on commercial markets instead.”

Your Answer:

Question 2 (Recall)

The federal fiscal year runs from:

- A. January 1 to December 31
- B. July 1 to June 30
- C. April 1 to March 31
- D. October 1 to September 30

Your Answer:

Question 3 (Scenario)

It's August, and your BD lead mentions that "Q4 spending is about to spike." Why is Q4 (July-September) critical for government contractors?

- A. Congress typically passes new legislation during this period
- B. Agencies must obligate remaining budget before the fiscal year ends on September 30, creating a surge in contract awards
- C. Federal employees take vacation, slowing down procurement
- D. This is when agencies plan next year's budget, not award contracts

Your Answer:

Question 4 (Recall)

What is the government-wide small business contracting goal?

- A. 15% of all contract dollars
- B. 23% of all contract dollars
- C. 30% of all contract dollars
- D. 50% of all contract dollars

Your Answer:

Question 5 (Application)

You want to research how much the Department of Veterans Affairs spent on IT services last year. Which tool should you use?

- A. SAM.gov Entity Search
- B. USAspending.gov Agency Profile
- C. Acquisition Gateway Forecast
- D. SBA Dynamic Small Business Search

Your Answer:

Domain 2: Opportunity Discovery & Customer Engagement (Questions 6-10)

Question 6 (Scenario)

You're a program manager on a current VA contract. During a status meeting, your government counterpart mentions they're "frustrated with the current help desk response times" from another contractor. What should you do?

- A. Ignore it—it's not your contract
- B. Note this as a potential opportunity signal and share it with your BD team
- C. Immediately pitch your company's help desk services
- D. Report the other contractor to the contracting officer

Your Answer: ☐

Question 7 (Recall)

Which SAM.gov feature allows you to find upcoming contract opportunities?

- A. Entity Registration
- B. Contract Opportunities (formerly FBO)
- C. Wage Determinations
- D. Exclusions Search

Your Answer: ☐

Question 8 (Scenario)

Your company provides cybersecurity services. You find a Sources Sought notice asking for information about companies that can provide "Security Operations Center (SOC) services for a mid-sized civilian agency." What is the primary purpose of responding?

- A. To win the contract immediately
- B. To help the agency understand market capabilities and potentially shape the requirement
- C. To file a protest against the procurement
- D. To negotiate pricing before the RFP

Your Answer: ☐

Question 9 (Application)

You've identified a contract that's expiring in 18 months. The incumbent is a large business, and you're a small business. This is called a:

- A. Sole-source opportunity
- B. Recompete opportunity
- C. New start opportunity
- D. Bridge contract

Your Answer:

Question 10 (Scenario)

You're preparing for a meeting with a contracting officer. Which approach is most appropriate?

- A. Focus entirely on selling your company's capabilities
- B. Ask about their challenges and upcoming needs while briefly explaining how you might help
- C. Request the draft RFP so you can start writing your proposal early
- D. Bring gifts to build rapport

Your Answer:

Domain 3: BD & Capture Fundamentals (Questions 11-15)

Question 11 (Recall)

In the capture lifecycle, which phase comes BEFORE proposal writing?

- A. Contract execution
- B. Positioning and competitive analysis
- C. Post-award transition
- D. Invoice submission

Your Answer:

Question 12 (Scenario)

Your BD team is evaluating whether to pursue an opportunity. The RFP requires Top Secret facility clearance, which your company doesn't have and would take 18 months to obtain. The proposal is due in 60 days. What should you recommend?

- A. Pursue it anyway and hope for the best
- B. No-bid due to a disqualifying gap that can't be resolved in time
- C. Submit without addressing the clearance requirement
- D. File a protest against the clearance requirement

Your Answer:

Question 13 (Application)

A "win theme" in proposal development is best described as:

- A. The lowest price you're willing to offer
- B. A compelling, differentiated message that explains why the customer should choose you
- C. The section headings in your proposal
- D. Your company's mission statement

Your Answer:

Question 14 (Scenario)

You're analyzing a competitor who has held the incumbent contract for 5 years. Their customer satisfaction scores are mediocre. What is this competitor's likely weakness?

- A. They have too much past performance
- B. Customer fatigue and potential openness to change
- C. Their pricing is definitely too high
- D. They will automatically win the recompetete

Your Answer:

Question 15 (Recall)

What is the recommended pipeline-to-revenue ratio for a healthy BD operation?

- A. 1:1 (pipeline equals annual revenue)
- B. 3:1 to 5:1 (pipeline is 3-5x annual revenue)
- C. 10:1 (pipeline is 10x annual revenue)
- D. Pipeline ratios don't matter

Your Answer:

Domain 4-6: Proposal Support, Compliance & Execution (Questions 16-20)

Question 16 (Scenario)

You're supporting a proposal team and they ask you to review the compliance matrix. What is the primary purpose of a compliance matrix?

- A. To track project costs after contract award
- B. To ensure every RFP requirement is addressed in the proposal with a specific reference
- C. To compare competitor pricing
- D. To schedule proposal writing tasks

Your Answer:

Question 17 (Recall)

What is required for a company to receive a federal contract award?

- A. A LinkedIn company page
- B. Active SAM.gov registration with valid UEI and CAGE code
- C. At least 10 employees
- D. A physical office in Washington, DC

Your Answer:

Question 18 (Application)

Your company's SAM.gov registration expires next month. What happens if it lapses?

- A. Nothing—registrations auto-renew
- B. Your company cannot receive new contract awards or modifications until re-registered
- C. Only prime contracts are affected, not subcontracts
- D. You have a 90-day grace period

Your Answer:

Question 19 (Scenario)

After winning a contract, the BD team wants to hand off to the delivery team. What information is MOST critical to include in the transition briefing?

- A. The names of competitors who lost
- B. Key commitments made in the proposal, customer expectations, and any known risks
- C. The total cost of the BD effort
- D. Marketing materials used during capture

Your Answer:

Question 20 (Recall)

Which small business certification allows sole-source contracts up to \$4.5M for services?

- A. WOSB (Women-Owned Small Business)
- B. HUBZone
- C. 8(a) Business Development Program
- D. SDVOSB (Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned)

Your Answer:

Answer Key

For Facilitator/Self-Grading Use Only

Q	Answer	Q	Answer	Domain
1	B	11	B	D1/D3
2	D	12	B	D1/D3
3	B	13	B	D1/D3
4	B	14	B	D1/D3
5	B	15	B	D1/D3
6	B	16	B	D2/D4
7	B	17	B	D2/D4
8	B	18	B	D2/D4
9	B	19	B	D2/D4
10	B	20	C	D2/D4

Scoring:

- 18-20 correct: Excellent—ready for Practitioner level
- 14-17 correct: Pass—review missed areas
- Below 14: Review modules and retake

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